

Dr. Elena Leuschner

Academic Positions

since 02/2025	Postdoctoral researcher , University of Münster, at the Chair of Comparative Politics of Daniel Bischof
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Education

09/2020 - 01/2025	PhD , University of Gothenburg, Department of Political Science Thesis: “The Causes and Consequences of Government Concessions to Protest”, supervisors Carl Dahlström and Johannes Lindvall
10/2018 - 06/2020	MA , International Administration and Conflict Management with methods specialization, University of Konstanz (1,1)
09/2019 - 06/2020	MSc , International Administration and Global Governance, University of Gothenburg (with Distinction)
10/2014 - 09/2018	BA , Politics and Public Administration, University of Konstanz

Fellowships and visits

01/2024 - 04/2024	Visiting researcher , Oxford University, Department of Political Science and International Relations
05/2022	Visiting researcher , WZB Berlin Social Science Center Daniel Ziblatt, Transformation of Democracy Unit
03/2022 - 09/2024	Research assistant , University of Gothenburg, Carl Dahlström and Mikael Holmgren, Text analysis for “Setting the Agenda in the Swedish Riksdag: Partisan Politics and Commissions of Inquiry, 1971-2021”.
09/2019 - 09/2022	Research fellow , University of Konstanz, Steffen Eckhard, Research group ‘Public Administration and Organization Theory’

List of publications

Peer-reviewed papers

- 2024 Simon Gren and **Elena Leuschner**. 2024. “Outcome Isn’t Everything: Electoral Consequences of Implementing or Withdrawing Unpopular Policies.” *Political Behavior* 46: 2677–2697. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11109-024-09936-8>.
- 2024 **Leuschner, Elena**, and Sebastian Hellmeier. 2024. “State Concessions and Protest Mobilization in Authoritarian Regimes.” *Comparative Political Studies* 57(1): 3–31. <http://journals.sagepub.com/doi/10.1177/00104140231169022>.
- 2024 Eckhard, Steffen, Vytautas Jankauskas, and **Elena Leuschner**. 2023. “Institutional Design and Biases in Evaluation Reports by International Organizations.” *Public Administration Review*: 1–14. <https://doi.org/10.1111/puar.13705>.
- 2023 Eckhard, Steffen, Vytautas Jankauskas, **Elena Leuschner**, Ian Burton, Tilman Kerl, Rita Sevastjanova. 2023. “The Performance of International Organizations: A New Measure and Dataset Based on Computational Text Analysis of Evaluation Reports.” *The Review of International Organizations*. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11558-023-09489-1>.

Book chapters

- 2024 Sebastian Hellmeier, **Elena Leuschner**. 2024 “Elections and autocratization.” Aurel Croissant, Luca Tomini (Eds). *The Routledge Handbook of Autocratization*. Routledge. 166-180.

Other

- 2025 **Elena Leuschner**. 2025 “The Causes and Consequences of Government Concessions to Protests. <https://gupea.ub.gu.se/handle/2077/84117>.

Papers in progress

- 1 **Elena Leuschner**, Jesper Lindqvist, Jennifer Oser. Does the Effect of Political Participation Depend on the Status of the Participator?, with Jesper Lindqvist, Jennifer Oser (*in-principal-acceptance at JOP*, registered report)
- 2 Steffen Eckhard, **Elena Leuschner**, Jan Kemper. The Implementation of the World Food Program’s Peacebuilding Policy – An Analysis based on Country-level Reports (*R&R*, available as working paper).

- 3 **Elena Leuschner**. Peaceful, Large, and Actionable — Experimental Evidence from Belgium on Local Politicians’ Responsive Reactions to Protests (*under review*, available as working paper).
- 4 **Elena Leuschner**, Luca Versteegen. The Emotional Dynamics of Protest, (*under review*, available as working paper).
- 5 **Elena Leuschner**. Asymmetric Responsiveness: The Effects of Protesters’ Demographics and Policy Preferences on the Political Agenda (available as working paper).
- 6 Mirko Wegemann, **Elena Leuschner**, Tim Lars Allinger, Daniel Bischof, Kristian Frederiksen, Morgan Le Corre Juratic. What Citizens Mean by Democracy: Partisan Differences in Open-Ended Survey Responses (available as working paper).
- 7 **Elena Leuschner**, Daniel Bischof. Does Exposure to Anti-refugee Rallies Affect Political Behavior and Preferences – Evidence From the Far Right PEGIDA Movement in Germany.
- 8 **Elena Leuschner**, Mirko Wegemann, Daniel Bischof. Get Out to Participate: Evidence from a Field Experiment

Policy papers
in progress

- Carl Dahlström; Mikael Holmgren; **Elena Leuschner**. Den svenska policyprocessen, 1971-2026. Commissioned by The Expert Group on Public Economics (ESO) under the Swedish Ministry of Finance.
- 2023 Steets, Julia; Claudia Meier; Alexander Gaus; Sarah Bressan; Inji El Bakry; Steffen Eckhart; Jan Kemper; **Elena Leuschner** (external evaluation team). Evaluation of the Policy on WFP’s Role in Peacebuilding in Transition Settings. Centralized evaluation report. Commissioned by the World Food Program (WFP). <https://docs.wfp.org/api/documents/WFP-0000146160/download/>.

Conferences and invited talks

2026	Presenter: APSA (Boston), EPSS (Belfast), University of Vienna (Department Series), Sciences Po Paris (UNEQUALMAND workshop)
2025	Presenter: APSA (Vancouver), EPSA (Madrid), GEPOP Internal Conference (Gothenburg), Quality of Government conference (Gothenburg University), Zweitstimme Workshop (Berlin)
2024	Presenter: APSA (Philadelphia), EPSA (Cologne), ISA (San Francisco), Work in Progress Seminar Series (Oxford University)
2023	Presenter: APSA (Los Angeles, declined), EPSA (Glasgow), Comparative Institutions and Regimes Seminar Series (Oslo University), Comparative Politics Seminar Series (Lund University), General Research Seminar Series (Gothenburg University)
2022	Presenter: APSA (Montreal), ISA (Nashville, online), Public Administration and Public Policy (Gothenburg University), Quality of Government conference (Gothenburg University), Research Group on Elections, Public Opinion and Political Behavior (Gothenburg University)
2021	Presenter: ECPR General Conference (online), International Public Administrations Workshop (LMU Munich), Conflict Dynamics Workshop (Oxford, online), German Association of Peace and Conflict Studies (AFK) (Frankfurt, online)
2020	Presenter: ECPR General Conference, (presenter, online)

Teaching

2026	Substitute lecturer: Political parties on the BA lecture “Introduction to Comparative Politics” by Daniel Bischof
2026	Lecturer: Marching on the Streets, but not Changing Minds? How Protests Mobilize, Strategize, and Succeed (BA), University of Münster
2026	Lecturer: Opportunities and Pitfalls of Political Participation and Representation (MA), University of Münster
2025	Substitute lecturer: Democratic preferences on the BA lecture “Introduction to Comparative Politics” by Daniel Bischof

2025	Lecturer: Democracy Needs You? Political Participation from a Comparative Perspective (BA), University of Münster
2025	Lecturer: Voices of Change? The Political Effects of Protests (MA), University of Münster
since 2025	Lecturer: Applied Introduction to R for Political Scientists (BA and MA), University of Münster
2022-2024	Lecturer: Introduction to Applied Research Design and Quantitative Research Methods for Social Scientist (MA), University of Gothenburg
2022-2024	Lecturer: The Swedish Welfare State (BA), University of Gothenburg
2021-2024	Teaching assistant on Academic Writing (MA), University of Gothenburg
since 2021	Supervising theses: 7 Bachelor theses and 2 Master theses

Awards and grants

2021	Best paper award, by the Journal of Comparative Policy Analysis for “ <i>Learning or contestation: Analyzing political biases in international organization evaluation reports</i> ”
2026	Leuchtturm Projekt Fördergesellschaft Universität Münster: (14,975 EUR)
2023	Royal Society of Arts and Sciences in Gothenburg: (75,000 SEK)
2023	Helge Ax:son (70,000 SEK)
2023	Siamon (11,840 SEK)
2023	W& M Lundgren (75,000 SEK)
2023	Donationsnämndens stipendier (15,000 SEK)
2023	Swedish National Election Studies (26,550 SEK)
2023	Lars Hiertas Minne Stiftelsen (30,000 SEK)
2022	Adlerbertska Stiftelsen (20,000 SEK)
2022	APSA travel grant (200 USD)
2021	Adlerbertska Stiftelsen (30,000 SEK)
2020	German Academic Exchange Service DAAD (8,600 EUR)

Academic services and memberships

Referee	American Journal of Political Science, British Journal of Political Science, Comparative Political Studies, Democratization, International Political Science Review, Journal of Conflict Resolution, Journal of Peace Research, Social Movement Studies, Social Problems
Memberships	American Political Science Association (APSA), European Political Science Society (EPSS), European Political Science Association (EPSA)

Special knowledge

Languages	German: native speaker; English: proficient user; French: proficient user
Software	R, Python, Stata, L ^A T _E X

References

Daniel Bischof	Professor, University of Münster dan.bischof(at)uni-muenster.de
Carl Dahlström	Professor, University of Gothenburg carl.dahlstrom(at)pol.gu.se
Johannes Lindvall	Professor, University of Gothenburg johannes.lindvall(at)gu.se

September 18, 2026